

provided. The Jasjar's multimedia capabilities are also quite decent and you will find the audio output from the stereo speakers to be adequate. Bluetooth worked well with the Jabra BT-200 wireless headset. Also usable was the device's WiFi module. We tried the latter with an Asus WiFi router and could connect without issues. Getting the Jasjar to work with GPRS was also simple. The device did not have any trouble figuring out which connections were live, and switching back and forth between WiFi and mobile networks was smooth. Browsing the Web with the inbuilt IE browser was passable. The large screen size makes working with spreadsheets, documents and Web pages simple. With its removable 1620mAh Lithium Polymer battery, you can expect a period of two days before looking for an available power socket, unless you use it extensively.

You don't really need to open the device to answer a call, just press the green button on the side and you can use the speaker provided on the outside. This involves holding the Jasjar close to

your ears, which doesn't look too smart. You would thus want to use the bundled wired headset or purchase a Bluetooth set, rather than hold a brick to your face. The QWERTY keyboard is an asset and can be used even with fairly large fingers. You will find that it is much better to use your thumbs for data input rather than use it laptop-style. With the keyboard, you will hardly need to remove the stylus since most functions can be performed using the keys. However, the significant weight of the device doesn't make it too convenient for prolonged use. The keyboard usability is enhanced by the presence of a light sensor that detects the amount of available light and if required, switches on a reddish backlight for the keys.

Overall, the i-mate Jasjar is a capable communications device for business users who can carry it in their executive briefcases and most importantly, can afford the price tag.

+ Integrated QWERTY keyboard, Dual mode GSM/WCDMA
- No EDGE, Bulky, Expensive
Rating: 3.5/5

Nokia 9300/9300i Communicator

All work and no play

After Nokia's brick-sized 9500 Communicator, comes its smaller siblings—the 9300 and the 9300i Communicators. 9300i is the newer of the two, major additions being the inclusion of Wi-Fi and Bluetooth 1.2, as compared to the 9300's Bluetooth 1.1. Both the 9300 and the 9300i are almost identical and you will hardly be able to tell the two apart if it were not for the 9300i's dark-grey casing, as opposed to the silver of the 9300.

Business-oriented, the Communicators are practical devices almost to the point of being boring.

Measuring 132 x 51 x 21 mm and tipping the scales at 172gm, you will not have any issues carrying these devices in your pocket. Apart from a small power key on the top, you will find a fairly large and comfortable numeric keypad and a 128 x 128 65K colour display as its fascia. It opens to a 640 x 200 pixel transreflective display with 65K colours. Four soft keys are placed on the right of the display. The bottom half has the QWERTY keyboard. Here, dedicated numerical keys and a row of eight application buttons (including a "My own" button that you can program) along with the five-way joystick make working with this device a breeze.

Powered by a processor running at 150 MHz, the 9300/9300i features 80 MB of shared internal memory and runs Symbian OS 7.0s on the Series 80 platform. Memory is expandable by way of MMC cards and a 128MB card is bundled. Thankfully, you don't need to remove the battery to access the memory card, though you still need to open the back cover. This triband GSM device with support for EGPRS and HSCSD also offers IR and Bluetooth. The WiFi in the 9300i is the fast 802.11g (54 Mbps) variant. Other features

include a native e-mail client that supports POP3, IMAP4, SMTP and Open Mobile Alliance data synchronisation; with attachment viewers. The phone also offers mobile fax, synchronisation with Outlook, a PDF viewer, an HTML browser, Office applications compatibility with the most common features of Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, and Excel, and finally speakerphone and conference call capabilities.

With support for 40 polyphonic ringtones and playback of common audio formats including MP3 and AAC, it is also possible to use it as a portable audio player. There is support for RealVideo, MPEG4, and H.263 video. Keeping its target audience in mind, the device does not have a camera. A lack of vibration alert is surprising, since users would surely want to be alerted discretely of incoming calls or messages during business meetings. Personalisation is limited to changing the theme and wallpaper.

Phone clarity on the 9300/9300i is excellent and we would expect nothing less from Nokia. Battery life too, is good. However, the phone could do with a speedier CPU—there is a noticeable lag while launching applications, though menu navigation and other operations seem to be fine. The keyboard should actually be called a thumb-board since it is more suited for typing short notes and e-mails using your thumbs. The five-way joystick, though comfortable on the thumb, is a little finicky and should be improved.

To conclude, both the 9300 and the 9300i are practical communications devices for business users who want a no-frills solution on the move.

+ Practical business usage, WiFi 802.11g on the 9300i
- No camera, No vibration alert
Rating: 3.5/5 (9300/9300i)



Nokia 9300i - The business phone